

January

22

### Born this day

**1912 August Strindberg**, Swedish author. He is best known as a playwright – he wrote more than 60 dramas in his lifetime.

### Also on this day

**1517 At the Battle of Ridaniya**, Sultan Selim I of the Ottoman Empire conquered the Mamluk forces and seized control of Egypt.

**1824 In a rare African victory** against colonial powers, the Ashanti defeated British forces along the Gold Coast in Ghana.

**1997 A metal piece from a disintegrating rocket** fell from the sky in Oklahoma, USA, and harmlessly hit Lottie Williams – the only person to be struck by space debris.

**2006**

### Bolivian president

Evo Morales took office as the first Indigenous president of Bolivia. He belongs to the Aymara, a South American Indigenous group based in the central Andes mountains.



**1506**

### Pope's bodyguards

Switzerland sent 150 soldiers known as Swiss Guards to protect Pope Julius II at the Vatican, the headquarters of the Roman Catholic Church. Today, Switzerland still sends guards to the Vatican, where they patrol in their brightly coloured uniforms.



**1879**

### Anglo-Zulu face-off

Britain waged war against the Zulus to expand its control over southern Africa. On the same day during the Anglo-Zulu War, Zulu warriors were victorious at the Battle of Isandlwana, while British forces triumphed at the Battle of Rorke's Drift.